

DARJEELING

The Darjeeling region of India may cover only 70sq miles (181sq km), but it produces one of the most famous teas in the world. Cool temperatures and high altitudes produce leaves with aromatic flavors that are highly acclaimed.

Located in the state of West Bengal in north India, Darjeeling sits at the edge of the Himalayas. A well-established tea-growing region, some of its 87 tea estates date back to the mid-1800s. Darjeeling produces only 1.13 per cent of India's total output of tea, but it is of such high quality that it is protected by Geographical Indication. This has, however, been difficult to enforce, and there are growers selling counterfeit Darjeelings, which have been padded with other Himalayan teas sourced from outside the designated Darjeeling region. The Tea Board of India

has developed a trademark logo for Darjeeling to help buyers identify authentic tea from the region.

Var. *sinensis* is grown here along with some var. *assamica* hybrids. The high elevation, 3,280–6,890ft (1,000–2,100m), influences the flavor of the finished tea. The leaves grow very slowly because they are constantly shrouded in cool mist. During the growing season, the plants respond well to warm days and cool evenings. These conditions help to create intense flavors in the leaves.



HARVESTING THE LEAVES

In Darjeeling, female workers hand pluck the leaves over three harvesting seasons, with the first flush starting in mid-March.

DARJEELING KEY FACTS

PERCENTAGE
OF WORLD
PRODUCTION: **0.36%**

MAIN TYPES:

BLACK,
OO LONG, GREEN, WHITE

FAMOUS FOR:

GEOGRAPHICAL INDICATION
AND DARJEELING TRADEMARK

HARVEST:

FIRST FLUSH
MARCH-APRIL

SECOND FLUSH
MAY-JUNE

AUTUMNAL FLUSH
OCTOBER-NOVEMBER

ELEVATION:

HIGH



Second flush
Darjeeling has
layered flavors
with distinct
notes of
muscat grape.